Northgate Community Food Bank AI use policy

Draft for board review · Effective when the board approves it · Owner: To be confirmed by the board (see open questions) · Next review: In 12 months

Why we have this policy. We want AI to save time on newsletters, posts and grant drafts. We must protect SNAP clients, donors and volunteers, and keep real people serving our community.

Who it covers. Staff, volunteers, contractors and board members.

TOOLS WE USE

- **Google Gemini (in Google Workspace):** Drafting in Gmail and Docs. No protected information.
- **ChatGPT (personal paid account):** Volunteer newsletters and social posts only. No protected information.
- **Claude:** Grant first drafts only. No protected information.
- **New tools, add-ons and AI features.** Ken approves any new tool, extension, plugin, agent or AI feature in existing software. He checks where our data goes first.

WHAT YOU CAN USE AI FOR

- Volunteer newsletters and social posts
- Volunteer thank-you notes
- Grant boilerplate and first drafts
- Drafting emails and documents in Gmail and Docs, with no protected information

NEEDS APPROVAL FIRST

- Any SNAP program work — *Marcus*
- Anything using donor data — *Marcus*
- AI use with a corporate partner's logo or brand — *Marcus*
- Summarizing recall notices or allergen information — *Your manager*

OFF LIMITS

- **Never put this into an AI tool** unless the tool is approved for it above: SNAP applicants' Social Security numbers, income, household members and immigration documents. Donor records in Salesforce. Volunteer names, phone numbers and emergency contacts. Court-ordered volunteers' case details. Mobile pantry sign-up names and zip codes. No tool above is approved for any of this.
- Never paste a SNAP application into any AI tool, even to help.
- No chatbot answers SNAP eligibility questions. A person answers the SNAP line.
- No AI images of hungry people. Our photos are real, with consent forms.

CHECK EVERYTHING BEFORE IT GOES OUT

- You check every AI draft for facts, names and tone. You own what you send.
- Check recall and allergen details against the original notice, never an AI summary.
- Report numbers for Feeding America and funders come from the inventory system, never from AI.

DECISIONS ABOUT PEOPLE

- AI never decides who gets food, SNAP help, a volunteer role or a consequence. A person decides.
- Only trained, certified outreach staff give SNAP eligibility information. AI does not replace them.

BEING OPEN ABOUT AI

- Check partner agreements for AI clauses and follow them. One partner already has one.
- If a donor, funder or partner asks how we use AI, we tell them honestly.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Tell your manager and Ken the same day, including if protected information went into an AI tool.
- Reporting a mistake is expected. You will not be punished for it.

WHO OWNS THIS POLICY

- The board's executive committee approves this policy and any changes.
- Your manager shares it with you. We review it every year.

OPEN QUESTIONS FOR THE BOARD

- Who owns this policy day to day: Marcus, Ken or someone else?
- Can volunteers, like group leaders writing shift notes, use AI? With which tools and limits?
- Should Ken review the AI reminder texts in our volunteer scheduling software, and should we label them? What does the corporate partner's AI clause require?
- Will next year's budget pay for AI accounts, or should personal accounts like ChatGPT stay allowed?

Sample policy for an invented organization, drafted by Fulton Ring from a mock 30-minute call. Not legal advice; not reviewed by a real nonprofit.